



Tandy Corporation/Radio Shack

News Release

For Release: FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

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November 8, 1984
RS-85-028

Tandy Introduces the Tandy® 1000, A New MS-DOS Computer

FORT WORTH, TEXAS -- At its annual shareholders' meeting today, Tandy Corporation announced the newest addition to its computer family, the Tandy® 1000 Personal Computer. The Tandy 1000 Computer provides capabilities equivalent to the IBM® PC Computer plus graphics and sound enhancements, yet is priced more than \$1,000 under an equivalent IBM PC.

"The Tandy 1000 comes with the new DeskMate integrated software package, the MS-DOS operating system, and BASIC for only \$1,199," said John V. Roach, President, Chairman and CEO of Tandy Corporation. "The DeskMate package provides the six most popular computing functions. And, the Tandy 1000 is fully compatible with the widest selection of software available."

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The Tandy 1000's design and 360K floppy disk format allow it to run "off-the-shelf" IBM PC software including Lotus' 1-2-3, Ashton-Tate's dBase III, and Multimate International's MultiMate.

Bundled with the Tandy 1000 is the exciting new Tandy-authored program known as "DeskMate." It is an easy-to-learn package including six applications: Text, Worksheet, Filer, Calendar, Telecom, and Mail. All applications are function-key driven, and commands closely parallel those used in the award-winning Tandy Model 100 Portable Computer. In addition, the DeskMate program contains several capabilities available from within any of the applications: Help, Calculator (a simple 4-function calculator), Alarm (a background function to remind you of appointments), and Phone (stores numbers for reference or auto-dialing). A "Host" mode allows remote access when you're away, and even provides an electronic mail system for use by you and anyone else you designate. Many of the applications in the DeskMate program use simplified and innovative methods not found in other software.

The Tandy 1000 accepts up to three IBM-PC plug-in option cards (up to 10 inches long), and memory is expandable from 128K to 640K. Its 90-key detached keyboard is the same as used on the ultra-high performance Tandy 2000 computer.

Monochrome and color graphics to 640 x 200 dot resolution are built in, as are parallel printer, joystick and light pen ports. Both composite audio/video and RGB outputs permit the Tandy 1000 to display on an existing TV (through a low-cost RF modulator) or an optional monitor. Display modes are user selectable at 40 or 80 characters by 25 lines.

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Graphics and sound enhancements, not available on the IBM PC, are standard in the Tandy machine, including a three-voice sound and music generator.

The Tandy 1000 uses an 8088 16-bit microprocessor, operating at 4.77 MHz - the same as the IBM PC. It runs most programs at approximately the same speed as the IBM PC, or in some cases even faster, due to Tandy design improvements.

This new Tandy-designed and manufactured computer, with one floppy disk drive and 128K of memory (Cat. No. 25-1000) is available now for \$1,199.

A 12-inch high resolution green screen, non-glare monitor, Model VM-2, (Cat. No. 26-3211) will retail for \$159.95. A 13-inch high resolution color non-glare monitor, Model CM-2, (Cat. No. 26-3212) will be \$549.95. Other options available at introduction will be a second 360K disk drive (installation recommended) (Cat. No. 25-1005, \$299.95), a Touch Pad (Koala type) (Cat. No. 26-1185, \$59.95), a 128K Memory Expansion (expands on board to 256K) (Cat. No. 25-1004, \$299.95), an RS-232 Serial Interface Card (Cat. No. 25-1006, \$99.95) and a 300-baud Direct-Connect Modem Card (Cat. No. 25-1003 \$179.95). The RS-232 is not required for the modem.

These products are available at Radio Shack Computer Centers and participating dealers. Future options will include a hard disk interface card, light pen, mouse and local area network card.

Radio Shack is a division of Tandy Corporation.

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